

# ACCESSIBILITY PLAN & BARRIER REMOVAL POLICY MANUAL

*Identifying, removing, and preventing barriers for Individuals, employees, and key partners — CLBC Service Standards 2025*

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| <b>Document Reference</b>            | ECC-ACCESS-POL-2026-001                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Version / Effective Date</b>      | 1.1 — July 2026 (adds MCFD/CLBC/COA compliance cross-reference, Section 11)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Approved By</b>                   | Executive Director                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Review Date</b>                   | July 1, 2027 (annual)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Applies To</b>                    | All staff, casuals, students, contractors, subcontractors, and volunteers at all ECC programs — MCFD (children & youth) and CLBC (adult) streams; Individuals accessing services; key partners                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Legislative / Standards Basis</b> | Accessible British Columbia Act (ABCA) and Accessibility Standards; BC Human Rights Code (duty to accommodate); CLBC Service Standards 2025 s.1 (Organizational Oversight — accessibility planning) and s.3 (community participation); MCFD SHSS Standard B.1 (rights information in an understandable form) and D.1/D.4 (respect, dignity, community participation); COA ASE 1–5 (Administrative & Service Environment — accessibility of the physical and service environment); COA SDA (service delivery administration — accessible feedback); CARF 1.A, 1.K (accessibility of the organization and its services) |
| <b>Related Documents</b>             | ECC-RC-POL-2026-003; ECC-HC-2026-001; ECC-IIME-2026-001; ECC-HR-POL-2026-001; ECC-CSGAC-POL-2026-001; ECC-OHS-POL-2026-002; ECC-REQREG-2026-001 (item — Accessibility Plan)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |

## 1. Policy Statement

Every Individual accessing Evergreen Community Care's services, and every employee, contractor, subcontractor, and volunteer working within them, has the right to participate fully without being held back by a barrier the organization could have identified, removed, or prevented. Accessibility planning is not a one-time project: barriers are identified on an ongoing basis, acted on with a named owner and a timeline, and reviewed on a recurring cycle (ABCA; CLBC Service Standards 2025 s.1 — Organizational Oversight; COA ASE 1–5).

A barrier is always treated as a feature of the environment, a policy, a practice, or a communication method — never as a shortcoming of the person experiencing it. Accessibility planning is done with Individuals and their support networks, not to them (MCFD SHSS B.1 — rights and information in an understandable form; CLBC Service Standards 2025 s.3 — community participation).

This manual satisfies the accessibility planning requirement set out in CLBC Service Standards 2025, the accessibility and dignity provisions of MCFD SHSS Standards B and D, and the Administrative & Service Environment (ASE) accreditation standards of the Council on Accreditation (COA). Section 11 maps each part of this manual to the specific MCFD, CLBC, and COA requirement it satisfies.

## 2. Definitions

|                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Barrier</b>                  | Anything that hinders the full and equal participation of a person, including physical, architectural, technological, attitudinal, communication, or policy/practice barriers         |
| <b>Accessibility plan</b>       | This manual and its supporting logs and checklists, describing how ECC identifies, removes, and prevents barriers on an ongoing basis (ABCA requirement for prescribed organizations) |
| <b>Key partners</b>             | Funders (MCFD, CLBC), contracted service providers, health care providers, community agencies, and other organizations ECC regularly works with to deliver services                   |
| <b>Reasonable accommodation</b> | A change to a policy, practice, or environment that removes a barrier for a specific person, made without undue hardship to the organization (BC Human Rights Code)                   |
| <b>Attitudinal barrier</b>      | A barrier created by assumptions, stereotypes, or exclusionary language or practice, rather than by the physical or communication environment                                         |

## 3. Identifying Accessibility Needs

### 3.1 Individuals

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Learn at admission</b>   | Communication preferences, mobility/sensory needs, and any accommodation for full participation — recorded on the Communication and Accessibility Profile and reviewed at every care/service plan review (MCFD SHSS Standard E — individual service planning; CLBC Service Standards 2025 s.3) |
| <b>Who identifies needs</b> | The Individual, their supporters, and health/support providers — never assumed from a diagnosis or file alone                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Communication format</b> | Plain language, visual supports, interpreter, alternate formats, extra time, or a trusted supporter present, as the Individual prefers (MCFD SHSS B.1 — rights information in an understandable form)                                                                                          |
| <b>Ongoing review</b>       | Needs are re-confirmed at every plan review, not only at admission, since needs can change over time (COA ASE 3 — periodic reassessment of accessibility needs)                                                                                                                                |

### 3.2 Employees, Contractors, Subcontractors, and Volunteers

|                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Onboarding</b>                              | Accessibility and accommodation needs discussed at orientation; staff may raise a need at any point in employment without a formal diagnosis to start the conversation (COA HR — human resources; MCFD SHSS G.1) |
| <b>Accommodation requests</b>                  | Handled by the PM in partnership with the ED, per the HR Policy Binder (ECC-HR-POL-2026-001) and the BC Human Rights Code duty to accommodate                                                                    |
| <b>Contractors, subcontractors, volunteers</b> | Asked at engagement whether any accommodation is needed for their role; documented in their file alongside screening and training records (MCFD SHSS G.1; CLBC Service Standards 2025 s.1)                       |

### 3.3 Key Partners and the Community

|                                  |                                                                                                                                                                            |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Partner accessibility</b>     | Accessibility of communication and meeting arrangements with MCFD, CLBC, health care providers, and community partners reviewed as part of routine relationship management |
| <b>Partner-reported barriers</b> | A barrier a key partner identifies to working with ECC is logged and addressed using the same process as any other barrier (Section 5)                                     |

## 4. Identifying Barriers by Category

### 4.1 Attitudinal barriers

|                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Policies and materials</b> | All policy manuals, intake forms, and communication templates reviewed for exclusionary language or assumptions about capability, as part of the annual policy review                                         |
| <b>Practices</b>              | Reviewed against the Cultural Safety & Gender-Affirming Care Policy (ECC-CSGAC-POL-2026-001) and Code of Conduct, which already require dignity-based, assumption-free practice                               |
| <b>Culture</b>                | Staff training (orientation and annual refresher) includes an accessibility and dignity component; a dismissive or exclusionary pattern is addressed as a training, and where necessary a performance, matter |

### 4.2 Physical and environmental barriers (spaces used for service delivery)

|                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Monthly checklist</b>     | The PC completes a Physical Space Accessibility Checklist monthly, alongside — but distinct from — the OHS facility safety checklist: entryways, hallways, washrooms, common areas, signage, lighting, mobility/sensory barriers (COA ASE 2 — accessible physical environment; MCFD SHSS C.1) |
| <b>Logging</b>               | Any barrier identified is logged with a proposed remedy, distinguishing low-cost immediate fixes from structural/capital items requiring ED budget approval                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Interim accommodation</b> | Where a barrier cannot be fully remediated immediately, an interim accommodation is identified and documented until a permanent solution is in place (CLBC Service Standards 2025 s.1)                                                                                                        |

### 4.3 Communication barriers

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|-----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Individual level</b>     | Preferred communication format documented on the Communication and Accessibility Profile and used by all staff, not only the PC (MCFD SHSS B.1)                                                         |
| <b>Organizational level</b> | Key documents (Rights Statement, intake materials, complaint procedure) reviewed for plain-language and alternate-format availability; gaps logged (COA ASE 4 — accessible communication and materials) |
| <b>Interpreter gaps</b>     | Where an interpreter or specialized communication support is needed and unavailable, staff document the gap and escalate to the PC/PM the same day                                                      |

### 4.4 Community inclusion barriers

|                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Program design</b> | Transportation, scheduling, and activity design reviewed periodically for barriers to community participation, per the Community Inclusion and Access Policy (ECC-RC-POL-2026-003) (MCFD SHSS D.4 — community participation; CLBC Service Standards 2025 s.3) |
| <b>Direct input</b>   | Individuals are asked directly what would help them participate more fully; responses are incorporated into service and care planning, not treated as a one-time survey                                                                                       |

### 4.5 Other or reported barriers

Any barrier not captured above — reported by an Individual, family member, employee, contractor, volunteer, or key partner — is logged within 2 business days of being raised, using the same intake route as the Client Complaint Resolution Procedure (ECC-RC-POL-2026-003) where the person prefers to raise it that way.

## 5. Removing and Preventing Barriers

Every barrier logged is assigned a named owner and a target date by the PM within 5 business days of being identified or reported, mirroring the root-cause and corrective-action approach used across the Medication Administration Manual and Critical Incident Policy.

| Priority                          | Response Standard                                                                                                                                                           |
|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Immediate / safety-related</b> | Actioned within 24 hours (e.g., a blocked accessible route, a broken assistive device)                                                                                      |
| <b>Low-cost / operational</b>     | Actioned within 30 days (e.g., signage, furniture rearrangement, document reformatting)                                                                                     |
| <b>Structural / capital</b>       | Escalated to the ED for budget approval; a documented remediation timeline is set even where completion extends beyond a fiscal year, with interim accommodations meanwhile |
| <b>Policy / systemic</b>          | Reviewed by the PM and approved by the ED; implemented no later than the next annual policy review (July 1) unless the pattern indicates urgency                            |

Prevention: new or revised policies, forms, physical spaces, equipment purchases, and program activities are checked against accessibility considerations before being finalized or adopted, not only audited afterward.

## 6. Barriers Never Accepted

The following practices are prohibited under this policy and the BC Human Rights Code, subject to discipline up to termination and, where applicable, reporting to the funder:

|                                       |                                                                                                                               |
|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Treating a barrier as personal</b> | Framing a barrier as the Individual's or employee's own shortcoming rather than an organizational responsibility to address   |
| <b>Dismissing a reported barrier</b>  | Failing to log, assign an owner, or set a target date for a barrier raised by an Individual, employee, contractor, or partner |
| <b>No-accommodation default</b>       | Refusing a reasonable accommodation request without a documented undue-hardship assessment                                    |
| <b>Retaliation</b>                    | Any negative consequence toward a person for reporting a barrier or requesting an accommodation                               |

## 7. Responding to Reported Barriers and Concerns

|                            |                                                                                                                                                                             |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Individual / family</b> | Supported to report a barrier through any staff member, a supporter, or the Client Complaint Resolution Procedure; no reprisal ever; logged and reported to the PC same day |
| <b>Staff duty</b>          | Any staff member who becomes aware of a barrier logs it and reports to the PC within 2 business days                                                                        |
| <b>Escalation</b>          | Structural or capital barriers, or any barrier affecting safety, are escalated to the PM/ED the same day                                                                    |
| <b>Pattern review</b>      | PM reviews the Accessibility Barrier Log monthly; systemic fixes go to the corrective action log and are reported to the ED quarterly                                       |

## 8. Training Requirements

| Training                                     | Who                                      | When                                            | Renewal                 |
|----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| Accessibility awareness training (mandatory) | All staff, casuals, students, volunteers | At orientation, before working with Individuals | Annually                |
| Communication and Accessibility Profile use  | All program staff                        | At admission and each care plan review          | Per review              |
| This policy — read and acknowledged          | All staff                                | At orientation                                  | On each annual re-issue |

Training completion is tracked with MALM and first aid on the monthly staff-currency check (by the 5th) and is a condition of continued scheduling.

## 9. Roles and Responsibilities

|                  |                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>All staff</b> | Use each Individual's documented accessibility supports every shift; log and report any barrier observed or raised; complete mandatory training on time                                     |
| <b>PC</b>        | Maintains the Communication and Accessibility Profile for every Individual; completes the monthly Physical Space Accessibility Checklist; logs all reported barriers within 2 business days |
| <b>PM</b>        | Assigns an owner and target date to every logged barrier within 5 business days; escalates structural/capital barriers to the ED; reviews the log monthly; ensures staff training           |
| <b>ED</b>        | Approves this policy annually; approves budget for structural/capital remediation; ensures the Annual Accessibility Review is completed and reported to CLBC/MCFD                           |

## 10. Compliance Calendar

| Task                                                            | DUE DATE              | DATE DONE | INITIALS |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|-----------|----------|
| Accessibility awareness training — new staff before first shift | Per hire              |           |          |
| Training currency check (with MALM/first aid)                   | Monthly, by the 5th   |           |          |
| Physical Space Accessibility Checklist completed                | Monthly               |           |          |
| Communication and Accessibility Profile reviewed                | Each care plan review |           |          |
| Accessibility Barrier Log reviewed by PM                        | Monthly               |           |          |
| Quarterly pattern review — barriers/complaints                  | Quarter-end           |           |          |
| Annual Accessibility Review compiled and ED-approved            | By July 1             |           |          |
| Policy review and ED re-approval                                | July 1, 2027          |           |          |

## 11. MCFD / CLBC / COA Compliance Cross-Reference

This table maps each part of the manual to the specific MCFD, CLBC, and COA requirement it is built to satisfy, for use in funder review and accreditation preparation.

| Manual Section                      | MCFD SHSS                 | CLBC Service Standards 2025    | COA / CARF                      |
|-------------------------------------|---------------------------|--------------------------------|---------------------------------|
| 1. Policy Statement                 | Standard B.1              | s.1 — Organizational Oversight | COA ASE 1; CARF 1.A             |
| 3. Identifying Accessibility Needs  | Standard E                | s.3 — Service Planning         | COA ASE 3                       |
| 4.1 Attitudinal barriers            | Standard D.1              | s.1                            | COA ETH; COA ASE 1              |
| 4.2 Physical/environmental barriers | Standard C.1              | s.2                            | COA ASE 2                       |
| 4.3 Communication barriers          | Standard B.1              | s.3                            | COA ASE 4                       |
| 4.4 Community inclusion barriers    | Standard D.4              | s.3 — Community Participation  | COA ASE 5                       |
| 5. Removing and Preventing Barriers | Standard H.2 (QA)         | s.4 — Quality Assurance        | COA QI 1; CARF 1.E              |
| 6. Barriers Never Accepted          | Standard D.1/D.7          | s.1                            | COA ETH                         |
| 7. Responding to Reported Barriers  | Standard B.3 (complaints) | s.3 — Complaint Process        | COA SDA                         |
| 8. Training Requirements            | Standard G.1/G.3.2(b)     | s.1                            | COA TS (training & supervision) |
| 9. Roles and Responsibilities       | Standard H.1              | s.1                            | COA GOV 1/4/5                   |
| 10. Compliance Calendar             | Standard H.2              | s.4                            | COA QI; CARF 1.E                |

### Approval & Staff Acknowledgement

I have read and understood the Accessibility Plan and Barrier Removal Policy Manual (ECC-ACCESS-POL-2026-001). I understand the practice standards, the prohibited practices, and my responsibility to identify, log, and report accessibility barriers.

|                                                   |  |
|---------------------------------------------------|--|
| Executive Director — Signature / Date             |  |
| Program Manager — Signature / Date                |  |
| Staff Name (print) / Signature / Date             |  |
| Accessibility awareness training completed (date) |  |